



NASA to miss launch deadline

According to a post from the Planetary Society's blog, NASA is slated to miss its SLS launch deadline in November 2018 <http://dgit.in/MisseD>



Star Birth

See amazing pictures of destructive star births thousands of light years away from us. Head here: <http://dgit.in/StarDes>

A favourite of the science fiction audience an anti-gravity drive just seems to make sense. Just negate the very thing that ties you down to this rock. But the fact remains – anti-gravity drives just aren't close to reality. At all.

But they have inspired some very amazing work by agencies such as NASA



A Japanese company has already drafted construction plans for a space elevator.

and prestigious institutes like Gode Scientific Foundation. The goal has always been to create a device that creates a phenomenon that works opposite gravity. But as any seasoned physicist would tell you - we barely understand gravity. In the early days, gravity was presumed to be a force acting on mass until Einstein designed general relativity model, where gravity was just an effect of the curvature of space-time. And even as quantum physicists postulate that an anti-gravity particle may exist in nature - there is no proof or foundation for anti-gravity. Any inventions or technologies that have come and gone have been found to be either hoaxes or some other scientific phenomenon such as magnetism.

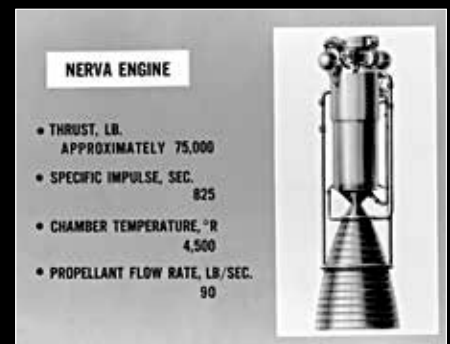
NERVA (Nuclear Engine for Rocket Vehicle Application)

NERVA or the Nuclear Engine for Rocket Vehicle Application was a two decade long program in the United States. It was active from 1952 and was a joint operation of the United States Atomic Energy Commission and NASA, aimed with the goal of using nuclear power to launch space

missions. The program was investigating the safety, efficiency and practicality of using nuclear fuel to make space travel more economical and faster. It worked tirelessly to develop new designs for rocket engines and associated propulsion systems. The program was able to bypass the Partial Test Ban Treaty as it did not call for atmospheric nuclear explosions and was designed to only direct nuclear generated power to its engines.

In 1968 the United States Space Nuclear Propulsion Office certified the NERVA engine NRX/XE to be a success. In fact, the standards of success were based on the ability of a rocket engine to carry out a manned mission to Mars at the time. The design was clean enough that it ensured

that no nuclear fallout would be inflicted on the Earth. The NERVA program was considered an all out success with support from everyone except the government of the United States. And with shifting priorities in the 1970s leaving politicians with no desire of investing in a Mars mission, the NERVA program was killed. Today it still remains as the baseline for any and



The NERVA project is the most realistic design for a nuclear powered rocket ever

all space programs that intend on using nuclear thermal rockets.

Project Daedalus

Project Daedalus was another one of the British Interplanetary Society's studies towards accomplishing unmanned interstellar spaceflight. While it was investigated years prior to the embryo filled Project Icarus, it did have its own brand of crazy - at least at the time. This is because the idea of Project Daedalus came in just three years after the Moon landing. While most of the world was still riding the high of having landed on the Moon, the scientists at the BIS were looking to travel to stars that were light years away. The very process statement for the project was futuristic in its conception which called for the construction of a 100,000 tonne spacecraft to be built in orbit and be powered by nuclear fusion engines.



The project was mostly inspired by Star Trek and LSD during the 1970s.